a revelation" (p. ix). He is to be congratulated on this real point of a fundamental contrast between Hinduism, on the one hand, and the revealed religions of the world, on the other. One wonders why he has not adhered to this distinction in his comparisons between Hinduism and Christianity and why for the purpose of this book he has treated Hinduism as being on a par with the revelatory religion of Christianity. Let us examine his reason for this.

His reason is that these religions (Hinduism and Buddhism) claim to be "revelations." "There is no doubt that the Hindus regard their own Veda as being in *some sense* a revelation" (p. ix). It is exactly here that Zaehner has erred grossly. The Hindus do regard their Vedas in *some sense* as a revelation, and they do regard their Rāma and Krishna as divine incarnations, but only in *some sense,* as Zaehner himself has said, and not at all in the exclusive sense in which a Christian or a Zaehner would like to regard them. The meaning of the term revelation when a Hindu uses it and when a Christian uses it is *totally different.* If Zaehner had maintained his original insight that Indian religions are not revelations but only unaided discoveries of the Hindus in the realm of the Divine, he would have easily seen that none of the conclusions he draws about them actually follow. Though Zaehner says that the Indian religions are not revelatory religions, he treats and judges them completely as if they were. In comparisons between religions, one can certainly draw such contrasts as empirical and revelatory, as Zaehner has done, but then, one certainly should hesitate to evaluate the one from the standpoint of the other.

It is true that the term "revealed" is used by the Hindus for the Vedas, and the idea of divine incarnation is used for Rāma, Krishna, Vishnu, and other earlier deities, but not at all in the sense in which a Christian regards Jesus Christ as the Son of God, or the Gospels as his revelations. The term "revelation," too, is empirical in the Hindu mind. When the content of a book or the character of a hero is considered as revealed, it means only that they are regarded as truer than others, and it merely shows that the highest regard and respect is given them in the minds of their followers. That the Vedas are revealed means only that they are so old as to be timeless, and the knowledge therein is supposed to have been directly or intuitively known to their authors and not that God actually spoke to them. That Rāma and Krishna are held to be divine incarnations means that they were such great men in their times, that their characters and personalities showed such values that they have become idolized and have become the ideals for men for all ages. Incarnation of godhood is a Hindu's highest